

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn

CENTRAL FOCUS

Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn

- [1] Method means procedure of inquiry; approach means procedure plus criteria for selecting problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

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- [2] Traditional and contemporary are historical labels; they do not exactly coincide with normative and empirical. (PDF pp.109-110)

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v

- [3] Empirical inquiry studies what can be observed and tested; normative inquiry judges what ought to be preferred or prescribed. (PDF pp.110-112)

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v

- [4] Behaviouralism pushed political science toward scientific study of actual political behaviour, regularities, verification and quantification. (PDF pp.118-121)

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v

SYNTHESIS -> Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Empirical and Normative Inquiry by Content

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Empirical and Normative Inquiry by Content

- [1] Gauba begins by separating method from approach so that students do not confuse tools of inquiry with frames of inquiry. (PDF pp.108-109)

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- [2] He then warns that traditional/contemporary and normative/empirical are not identical pairs. (PDF pp.109-110)

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- [3] He clarifies that empirical vs normative turns on the content of the claim, not just the grammatical presence of "is" or "ought". (PDF pp.110-112)

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- [4] The traditional approaches are then outlined: philosophical, historical, legal and institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Traditional Approaches and Their Thinkers

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Traditional Approaches and Their Thinkers

[1] Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions and data count as relevant. (PDF pp.108-109)

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[2] Traditional vs contemporary: the first cluster is associated with philosophy, history, law and institutions, while the second focuses more on process, behaviour and.

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[3] Empirical vs normative: empirical asks what is observable and testable; normative asks what is right, just or preferable. (PDF pp.110-112)

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[4] Form vs content: a sentence using "ought" may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition, while a sentence using "is" may still be.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Illustrations, Comparison and Trap Repair

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Illustrations, Comparison and Trap Repair

- [1] "Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work" is empirical in content because its claim can be checked against political functioning. (PDF pp.110-111)

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- [2] "Justice is treating equals equally..." is normative in content even though it appears in the form of an "is" statement. (PDF p.110)

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- [3] Legal analysis of Indian politics would ask what constitutional provisions authorize institutions and actions. (PDF pp.115-116)

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- [4] Institutional analysis would map legislature, executive, judiciary, parties and their formal relations. (PDF pp.116-117)

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline

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Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline

[1] Behaviouralism: scientific study of actual behaviour, eight key tenets, micro-level reliability. (PDF pp.118-121)

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[2] Post-behaviouralism: relevance, action and responsible value concern without discarding scientific gains. (PDF pp.121-122)

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[3] Best answer line: political inquiry needs both disciplined evidence and defensible value judgment.

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[4] Primary source used directly: Gauba, Ch.4, especially PDF pp.108-122 for basic distinctions and the behavioural/post-behavioural debate.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Behaviouralism's Eight Tenets

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Behaviouralism's Eight Tenets

[1] These eight "tenets"/"intellectual foundation stones" are commonly attributed, via Gauba's exposition, to David Easton's account of behaviouralism (echoing Easton's.

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[2] Techniques – rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.

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[3] Quantification – precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.

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[4] Values – an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).

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SYNTHESIS -> Behaviouralism's Eight Tenets is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action

- [1] Post-behaviouralism, associated with Easton's own self-correction, retains the scientific gains of behaviouralism (rigour, verification, technique) but adds two.

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- [2] Post-behaviouralism is a corrective within science, not a licence for unexamined activism; relevance still requires disciplined evidence, or it collapses back into.

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- [3] Post-behaviouralism kept scientific gains but demanded relevance, action and value-conscious responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)

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- [4] Pure science vs relevance: behaviouralism stressed reliable inquiry; post-behaviouralism added action and public responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Easton and Almond: Systems and Structural Functions

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Easton and Almond: Systems and Structural Functions

- [1] Claim: the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from.

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- [2] Evidence/mechanism: stability is explained by the system's capacity to convert demands into outputs faster than demands accumulate, and by supports (loyalty.

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- [3] Significance: allows comparison across very different polities using one common vocabulary (inputs/outputs/feedback), and foregrounds system persistence and.

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- [4] Limit: criticised as too static/equilibrium-biased; weak at explaining the internal distribution of power, ideology, or discontinuous change such as revolution, and.

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Deutsch, Decision-Making, Marxian Analysis and Model Comparison

[1] Claim: government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) – decision-making.

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[2] Evidence/mechanism: concepts such as information "load," "lag," "gain" and "lead" describe how efficiently a political system receives, processes and acts on.

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[3] Significance: foregrounds learning, error-correction and adaptive capacity in political systems, useful for analysing bureaucratic responsiveness and policy.

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[4] Limit: the mechanistic/engineering metaphor understates power, ideology and class conflict, and is not well suited to explaining revolution, resource allocation.

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SYNTHESIS -> Deutsch, Decision-Making, Marxian Analysis and Model Comparison is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

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Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

[1] Objection: behavioural political science's value-neutrality claim makes it complicit in ignoring urgent injustice, since choosing what to study/ignore is itself a.

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[2] Objection: structural-functionalism's claim to be structure-neutral is not honoured in practice – comparative studies routinely measure non-Western/developing.

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[3] The decision-making approach can be used to analyse how an Indian policy choice (e.g. a Cabinet or Cabinet Committee decision) moves from problem recognition to.

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[4] The structural-functional approach can compare India's formal parliamentary structures with informal interest-articulation channels (caste associations, kinship.

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SYNTHESIS -> Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

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MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

- [1] Best answer line: political inquiry needs both disciplined evidence and defensible value judgment.

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- [2] This basic file reconstructs behaviouralism's eight tenets and all five analytical models (systems, structural-functional, communications/cybernetic.

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- [3] Limit: functionalism's assumption that systems tend toward equilibrium risks a conservative bias (downplaying conflict and structural change), and in practice often.

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- [4] Objection: structural-functionalism's claim to be structure-neutral is not honoured in practice – comparative studies routinely measure non-Western/developing.

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v

SYNTHESIS -> PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.